

Wartime Experiments

The end of the fighting in November 1918 came as a surprise to Allied commanders. They had been planning to use large numbers of tanks and armored vehicles during 1919, many of which already existed in small numbers and were being prepared for combat. At the end of the war, the British were developing a wide range of specialized armored vehicles, including artillery carriers, bridgelayers, infantry carriers, supply tanks, and repair vehicles. Only a few of these saw service, however.

▷ **Mark V****

Date	1918	Country	UK
Weight	38.1 tons (34.5 tonnes)		
Engine	Ricardo gasoline, 225 hp		
Main armament	6 x .303 Hotchkiss Mark I* machine guns		

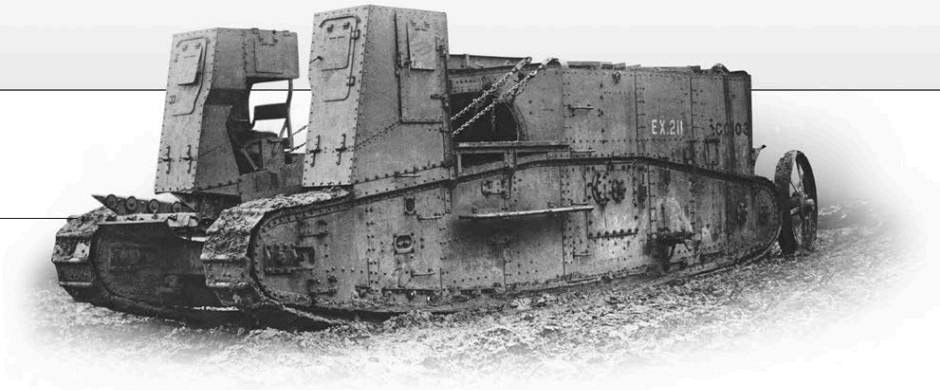
To cross wider German trenches, the British used fascines or cribs, and designed new, longer tanks. The Mark V* was essentially a stretched Mark V, while the Mark V** featured a more powerful engine and redesigned track layout.

▽ **Mark VIII**

Date	1918	Country	UK, USA
Weight	41.4 tons (37.6 tonnes)		
Engine	Ricardo gasoline, 300 hp		
Main armament	2 x QF 6-pounder 6-cwt Hotchkiss L/23 guns		

The Mark VIII "International" was an Anglo-American design intended to be built in France and used by the Allies. It was the first British-designed tank to separate the engine from the crew, improving conditions. After the war, 100 were built in the US, serving until 1930.

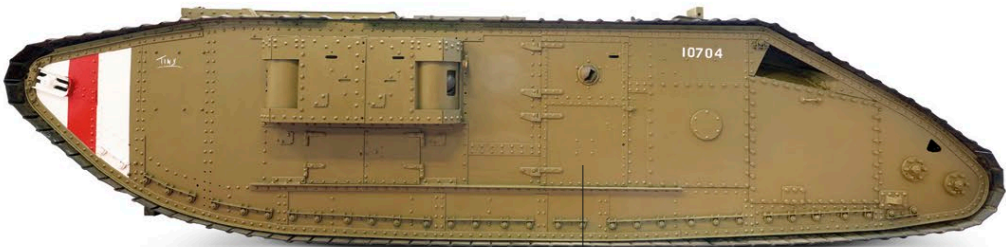
Low tracks



△ **Gun Carrier, Mark I**

Date	1917	Country	UK
Weight	38.1 tons (34.5 tonnes)		
Engine	Daimler gasoline, 105 hp		
Main armament	None, but carried 60-pounder or 6in artillery piece		

Mechanically based on the Mark I, the Gun Carrier was designed to carry an artillery piece and crew in order to provide fire support to advancing infantry. Fifty were built and saw some action in their intended role, but they were mainly used to carry supplies. In 1918 they were permanently converted for this function.



Side door



External frame

Return rollers

Riveted hull armor



◁ **Mark IX**

Date	1918	Country	UK
Weight	41.4 tons (37.6 tonnes)		
Engine	Ricardo gasoline, 150 hp		
Main armament	2 x .303 Hotchkiss Mark I* machine guns		

Officially called a tank, the Mark IX was in fact the first Armored Personnel Carrier (APC), carrying 30 infantrymen. It was underpowered as it used the same engine as the Mark V, but weighed 10 tons (9 tonnes) more. One Mark IX was used for trials as an amphibious tank, with large floats attached to the side.